

BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO KETTLEBELL TRAINING

HOW TO BUILD STRENGTH,
MUSCLE AND A SHREDDED BODY.
FULL BODY WORKOUT



P A U L W O L F

Beginner's Guide To Kettlebell Training

How To Build Strength,
Muscle And A Shredded Body.
Full Body Workout

By

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Introduction

Kettlebells offer an excellent fitness routine by combining muscle strengthening workouts, with cardio exercises to increase fitness and improve endurance. You no longer need to spend hours in the gym; an excellent Kettlebell workout takes as little as 15 minutes (three times a week) to achieve the same results. Kettlebells are an ideal fitness program for men or women looking for the quickest results in the shortest amount of time.

The Kettlebell or Gilya is a traditional Russian cast-iron weight, that looks a bit like a small bowling ball (without the finger holes) with a large handle on the top. Some modern versions feature adjustable weights or a rubber coating, their weights can range from about 2kg to around 79kg, but the traditional Russian Kettlebell usually weighed 1 Pood (pud), roughly 16kg/35lbs. Kettlebells were so popular in Russia that all weightlifters or strongmen were referred to as Girevik or “Kettlebell man”. The Russian Special Forces and regular soldiers all train with Kettlebell weights

Kettlebell exercises focus around three core lifts - the swing, the snatch and the clean and jerk. All these routines force all the muscles to work as a group, strengthening your core and building core stability as well. Every single muscle is used, and every single muscle is worked hard, this is why Kettlebells are gaining popularity because they work the entire body in less time than other forms of exercise.

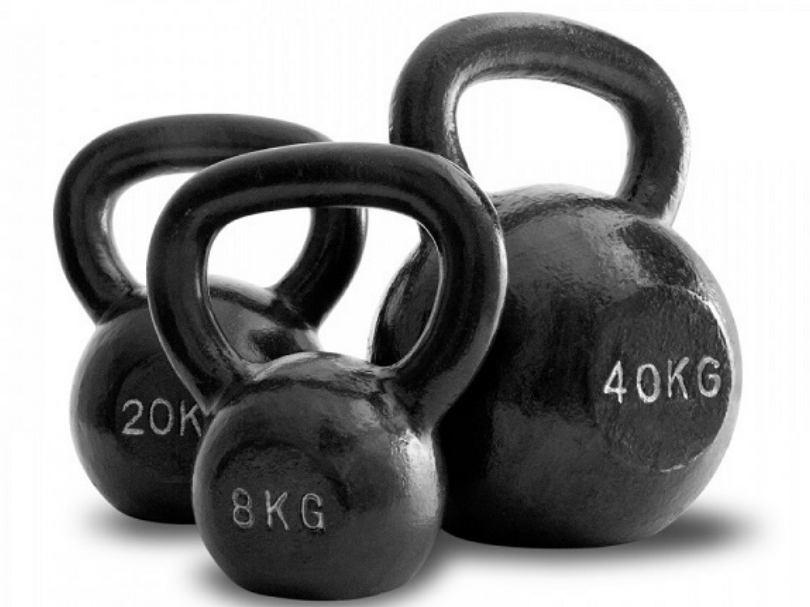
Kettlebell routines combine aerobic and strength exercises, which keeps training time to a minimum but still gives maximum results. For example, during a swing exercise, power is generated from the hips, the Kettlebells work out the abdominals while strengthening the core. All the muscles are working together to give an efficient and effective exercise.

Let's Begin!!!

What Size Kettlebells Should I Buy?

You never want to start off with a weight that is too heavy. This is the number one problem with many of today's lifters today no matter what equipment they choose to use. Particularly with the beauty of kettlebells where users can use momentum to sling heavyweights. But do not get drawn into the temptation of starting off too heavy. I always want to emphasise on starting with lower weights with 100% perfect form. The advantages of the perfect form are endless. It prevents injuries, builds stabilising and secondary muscles, and engages muscle growth in a balanced way. Plus you can always graduate to heavier weights later.

What factors to consider when choosing your weight? What is your body weight? What is your current fitness level?? What are your workout goals? Have you used kettlebells before? Are you working out by yourself or with a partner? Are you looking to do explosion exercises? Who will be using these kettlebells? How old are you? All these questions should be asked when deciding on the weight and number of kettlebells you should buy.



Now with that said, you obviously want the optimal weight to give you the best workout and push your body. The general suggested weight from most reliable sources say men should start off with a

35lb (16kg) and women should start out with 18lb (8kg). However, this does not take into account weight class or experience. Nor does this take into account the primary types of exercises expected to be performed or level of intensity. And if you are like me, I love using multiple sized weights for all my workouts.

Beginning average size males (190lbs) who are newer to fitness or kettlebell exercises should go with a 25lb kettlebell for the explosion and higher rep speed and a 35lb kettlebell to really focus on muscle hypertrophy (muscle gains). Again this is not the word of God, so feel free to adjust this to your comfort. Just make sure you have your heart rate up, feel sore after a workout, and are under control of your form during your workout.

Beginning average sized females (150lbs) who are newer to fitness or kettlebell exercises should go with a 12lb kettlebell and an 18lb kettlebell. Females are a bit harder to predict since there tends to be such a wide variety of body shapes and sizes. The typical female is looking for more muscle tone and cardio workout. If these are your goals, definitely stick to the lower weight ranges that allow to pump out high quantity high-quality reps.

Bodybuilders obviously want the higher weight range such as 35lb - 75 lb kettlebells. A great indicator for weight range would be to look at your go to dumbbell weights. And if you are looking to really take your fitness serious you should consider buying 3-5 different weights so you can really push your body in a variety of ranges and speeds.

Elderly or well-seasoned kettlebell enthusiasts really want to go on the light side of the spectrum. Assuming your goals are to just keep your muscles healthy and active and you are not planning on entering any Mr Universe competitions anytime soon. No matter your gender, start on the introduction sizes of 5lb - 15lb kettlebells.

How many should I buy? Ideally, you would have a full rack, but unless you are willing to drop a few thousand dollars this isn't going to be the best financial decision for you. I always recommend having at least two sizes. One weight should be on the lighter side for higher rep sets, and one should be on the heavier side for low rep sets. This should satisfy the majority of fitness programs and body types out there. Studies have shown that mixing weight size and number of reps can lead to the best muscle growth possible. So you don't want to have just one kettlebell around. Many professional

level workout regimens have “hard” days and “easy” days. Having a couple of kettlebell weights laying around help keep your workout consistent. Also keep in mind that if you have a workout partner, make sure neither one of you is compromising for the other just only to have to buy one kettlebell. These are investments for your future self!

So what is the ultimate answer? Well, there is none really. There are a lot of factors to consider. Each person and their goals are different. Just remember to keep form a priority and to start off with just a couple different sizes as you continue to grow.

Benefits Of Using Kettlebell For Training

Have you even wondered how Kettlebell exercises could remove stress in your system? With all these government and environmental issues we all face, it is not surprising to know that many people would want to get away from life's stresses. To remove stress, some individuals opt to engage in unhealthy habits like drinking, smoking and eating unhealthy foods. This, however, did not avert them from stress rather make it worse. You will increase your chance of getting sick or ill.



It is then advisable that the measures that you should take in averting stress must be healthy to lessen stress levels. Healthy habits would not only make you look good but also makes you feel better; however, it often takes effort and money. It is therefore not practical to take gym classes because of the present economic situation we have. Lucky enough, there is no longer need to visit the gym just to achieve and healthy and fit body. What are actually needed here are some loose clothes, extra space and Kettlebell. This is way much better than having to worry about going back and forth to the gym, and worry about your outfit and spent extra money.

To get the best body and health, one can simply do Kettlebell exercises for like 20 to 30 minutes for three times a week. Burning fat is easy with any cardiovascular exercises, but if you want to increase your muscle mass, then it is good to add a little tension and weights using the Kettlebell. Having extra muscle could help

increase your metabolism thus making you burn more fats and consume more energy thus making you learn faster.

Moreover, doing exercise is not the only solution to a healthier and leaner body. To fuel up our system, we need as well enough nutrients and vitamins that we can only get from the foods and drinks we take. We must make sure that we balance every food on our meals. After meals, there is nothing better to relieve stress than doing exercise. It takes away any negative stuff in our body.



If you prefer to use exercise equipment on your regular exercise programs but cannot find one, then do research or better yet, use Kettlebell to substitute them all. It is also advisable that you consult first your physician to have a check up if your body is resistant enough to carry all the strenuous Kettlebell exercises. There might be conditions that would not allow you to do it. If there is no problem and you are good to go, then you are on your way to achieving a healthy and fit body.

Would you like to know how Kettlebell Training can help you get in great shape without having to inconvenience yourself with trips to the gym? Surely everyone would like to build a slimmer and more fit physique and increase their energy level and self-confidence. However, finding a good workout program for the entire body and the cardiovascular system can be a painstaking review of trial and error.

Thankfully, training with kettlebells offers a versatile solution for addressing all the issues involved in building a great physique. Here are five of the top benefits of Kettlebell Training.

Building Lean Muscle

Most people do not consider the importance of building lean muscle when it comes to getting in shape. However, the muscles do a little more than just make the body look good. Muscles also play a key role in your metabolism and energy level, and they help the body to burn fat. The strength training dynamic of Kettlebell Training gives the opportunity to build lean muscle and to condition the cardiovascular system the same time.

Versatile Resistance Training

When it comes to versatility, using kettlebells beats out just about every other kind of training that there is. Not only are they more convenient than free weights or machines, which often require the time-consuming trip to the gym, but the construction of the Kettlebell is also done in such a way that it uses more muscle groups to keep the weight controlled.

This means that Kettlebell Training can effectively work every muscle group and every angle in order to encourage more well-rounded strength building and flexibility. Powerlifters, professional athletes, law enforcement officers, and professional fighters all use kettlebells to get the resistance which will help them build strength and agility that's useful in real life situations.

Cardiovascular Training

No matter what kind of training you are doing, the need for thorough cardiovascular training is vital. Good cardiovascular training helps the cardiovascular system to effectively distribute blood and oxygen to the muscles and brain. This enables the body to use the strength that it has while increasing the brain's ability to focus more and for longer periods of time.

The cardiovascular dynamic of a kettlebell routine can be done in conjunction with the strength training making the maximum use of exercise time.

Greater Self-Confidence

How much would more self-confidence you have if you could be stronger, more flexible, more agile and better fit than you had ever been in your life? The physical benefits of working out can provide a great increase in self-esteem for anyone who takes advantage of it. This increase self-confidence will give you the emotional energy that you need to continue your training and to continue to enjoy the physical benefits of Kettlebell Training. This increase in self-esteem is one of the most important benefits of Kettlebell Training.

Convenience

Possibly the most attractive thing about using Kettlebells is the convenience they offer. There are few other workout methods which allow you to work every muscle of the body in conjunction with the cardiovascular system (without having to go to the gym!). You can complete a very thorough Kettlebell Training session in the time it takes to commute to the gym!

Getting started with Kettlebell Training requires simply a few sets of Kettlebells and a training program specifically fit for your goals and body type.

Circuit Training Exercises Using Kettlebells

Circuit training exercises are very important in most sports specific training routines as they are often performed to mirror the activity of the sport in question.

For instance, in Boxing, amateur contests usually consist of four, two-minute rounds with a one minute break between rounds. This is a total of 12 minutes in length which doesn't sound too taxing, but please do not be fooled by how difficult this is. To replicate this, a Boxing coach will prepare possibly four stations for a Boxer; each station will require the athlete to perform at their absolute maximum for a two minute period as if participating in around of Boxing followed by one-minute rest. These types of training conditions the Boxer to work for a full two minutes at their maximum levels and to fully recover within the one minute's rest. By doing this over and over again, a Boxer will become the perfect athlete for their chosen sport.



The actual workstations used may or may not be Boxing related, with stations such as the Heavy Bag or the Boxing Pads the athlete will benefit from punching for two minutes at a time, but there is a lot to be said for the stations to be non-boxing related such as using a rowing machine, doing multiple repetitions of Kettlebell Swings or even something fundamentally simple such as star jumps. Whatever

the activity the Cardiovascular system and different muscle groups are working hard, and all the possible exercises combined help to develop the physical and mental strength of the athlete.

As eluded to above, kettlebell exercises have become very popular whatever the athletes sport when performing circuit training exercises. One of the main reasons for this is the total body workout effect of Kettlebell exercises; movements such as the Kettlebell Swing activate multiple muscle groups at once and also place heavy stress on the Cardio Vascular system. Boxing circuits, in particular, tend to favour the Kettlebell swing due to its reliance on the posterior chain to generate the power which is very similar to a striking movement in which a lot of the punching power a Boxer generates is from the bottom half of their body.

Circuit training exercises using kettlebells is one of the more popular methods of athletes incorporating the Kettlebells into their workouts and getting the most out of these canon balls like weights to push their physical progress onto the next level.

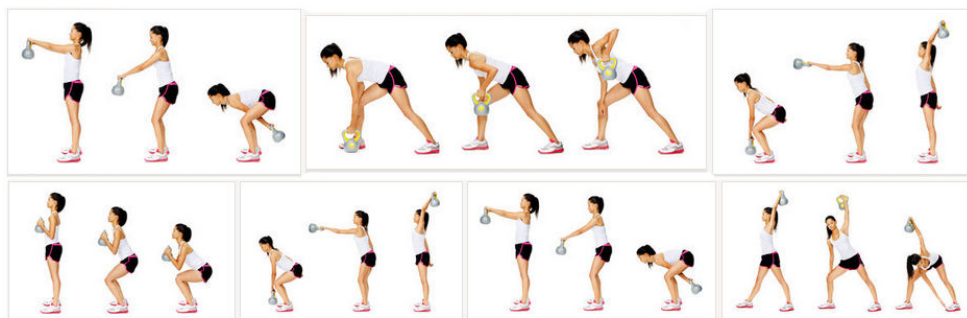
How to Perform Kettlebell Exercises

The wonders of kettlebell exercise is endless. For one, it doesn't take up too much space since a kettlebell is fairly small compared to a treadmill or even a gym ball. A Kettlebell exercise also doesn't require too much space. Even when you compare it to a jump rope activity, kettlebell exercises require an even small space to get yourself worked out. Above all, you need not go to the gym when you need to do kettlebell exercises.

Unlike other free weights, the techniques and variations of kettlebell workouts are just endless. Moreover, kettlebells can actually strengthen the entire body. To top that, you can even achieve the same cardio result at a much lesser amount of time.

Kettlebell workouts are not just for men but also for women. For one, women who often have complaints about not losing weight because of slow metabolism can actually do a kettlebell swing to shed those unwanted pounds. By incorporating ballistic exercises in a workout routine, women can boost their metabolism by doing swings and snatches with a kettlebell.

KETTLEBELL EXERCISES



Working out with a kettlebell can help decrease body fat in less amount of time. Women, regardless of their shape, size and weight will not only be able to reshape their body but also increase their muscle strength, increase their metabolism and even relieve stress in less amount of time.

Most workout routines, whether at home or in the gym after a while become boring and monotonous. It is very important to break away from that monotony and introduce new variations to your workout,

to keep yourself motivated. A good kettlebell workout can work on the muscles in a very different way than your body is used to. An intense Kettlebell workout has numerous cardiovascular and muscular benefits including fat loss. Kettlebell workouts have been found to be very useful in building up core stability, strength, improving speed and flexibility.



Many celebrities and Hollywood personalities have included kettlebell workouts to their regime. The kettlebell, originally from Russia, is fast gaining popularity in the west today. Initially, it was considered a training program for weightlifters, but with it all around benefits coming to light, many athletes and martial art students now workout with kettlebells.

Instead of going for a total kettlebell workout in the early stages, kettlebells can be used as finishers or can be thrown in between with your other weight training exercises. Initially, it is important to learn the manoeuvring of kettlebells, just like dumbbells, to prevent injury, so it's important to go and get some proper quality kettlebell training from a kettlebell instructor. Go to Russian Kettlebells Uk for Kettlebell Courses taught by qualified kettlebell instructors. Once the basic level is reached, you can gradually move to more advanced or complicated fluent movements which require greater coordination, fitness, speed and agility.



Unlike any other gym training, working out with kettlebells is very low cost, and the requirement is minimal. One does not need to invest much for a kettlebell workout, only a couple of kettlebells! You can choose from kettlebells according to their weights which range from two to one hundred pounds each. Lighter weight kettlebells should be used by beginners and once they get comfortable with the movements then heavier kettlebells can be used for more intense workouts. There are many variations and combinations that one can try with kettlebells. So if you want to work on your upper body, you can use kettlebells for doing regular pushups. On the contrary, swinging action, while holding the kettlebells, will strengthen the lower body muscles. All kettlebell exercises work hard to strengthen the core or torso while improving your flexibility at the same time.

A kettlebell workout gives you the flexibility to train anywhere since they are easily moveable. A kettlebell workout involves many muscles at the same time and is very beneficial for athletes who are required to work on their whole body, particularly, hamstrings, shoulders, and arms benefit a lot from kettlebell training. Moreover, intensive workouts with kettlebells can help you lose many calories in a very short period.

A kettlebell workout involves fast exercises like swings, cleans, jerks and snatches, which when done in high repetitions, gives incredible muscular endurance and bodily strength. A basic swing of the kettlebell is the first exercise which most people start with before

moving to the jerk and kettlebell snatch, which is the most complicated kettlebell exercise requiring fluent movements. The windmill kettlebell exercise works on the upper part of the body and improves your core strength, increases the flexibility of shoulders and improves your flexibility in your hamstrings. A properly planned kettlebell workout will not focus much on one area but give the whole body a good workout.

Kettlebell Press

The kettlebell press is a tremendous lift that certainly requires more from the lifter than meets the eye. If you want to learn how to press most any weight overhead with tremendous force and strength, then you have got to learn this lift. The kettlebell military press or overhead press is a tremendous strength building lift for your pressing needs.

If you have never pressed a kettlebell, then you are in for a big surprise. First of all, the bell is an awkwardly shaped device and handling it with any degree of control requires good feel and technique from the lifting participant. If we look at the press, you have really got to understand two different kettlebell lifts. You first have to understand how to clean and rack the bell first and then how to follow that up with pressing it. The clean and rack is the prerequisite position to get the bell before executing the military press or many other kettlebell lifts for that matter.



Without getting into too much detail on the clean and rack this part of the lift essentially gets the bell to a racked position at your chest with your arm at rest against your body. Your fist is just below your chin, and your legs are locked out with your feet slightly wider than shoulder-width distance apart in length. The key to holding the bell correctly at the rack requires you to lock your hips and knees by clenching your glutes (butt muscles) and tightening your quads (thigh muscles) to push your belly button up at an angle.

By getting in this position, you are forcing your hips forward and creating a shelf for your arm to rest up against your body while the bell is on the rack. This is a key component and position to be in before pressing the bell. Next, you will want to really create tension throughout your body ranging from your legs and glutes and also by increasing the pressure of your inner abdominal wall. This is done by you having to push air out through your diaphragm which causes tightness and stability throughout your abdominal wall. Breathing is important at this point because even though you are pushing air out you are not fully exhaling because this would destabilise your core centre. You should be exhaling partially and doing so with force as you begin the pressing motion of the bell.

As you start this, you will notice that your body will compress throughout your core centre and that you will have the sensation that you are more pushing yourself away from the bell overhead rather than pressing it overhead if that makes any sense. Its a unique feeling and most folks can only relate after experiencing it for the first time. As you press the bell, you are going to be doing so with a somewhat semi-circular pattern until it is locked out above your head. Once the bell is locked out then lower it in the same way as you pressed it. Don't just drop the bell back to the rack, but rather pull it back in a controlled manner until the weight is at rest again.



The key to doing this effectively is learning how to control your breathing and pressing pattern. It takes practice in order to execute the kettlebell military press. Take the time to practice and to do so with flawless technique. Remember that most anyone can train hard, but only the best train smart my friend.

Kettlebell Swing

The kettlebell swing is the fundamental movement for a great group of kettlebell movements.

The swing utilises a hip thrust that is important to other kettlebell movements such as the kettlebell clean and the kettlebell one arm snatch.

Learning to swing a kettlebell correctly will enable efficient and effective technique to develop maximum fitness, strength and endurance levels.

To begin a Two-Arm Kettlebell Swing start with the kettlebell slightly in front of you positioned between your legs that are wider than shoulder width. You should be looking ahead with your knees slightly bent, your back flat and your hips/butt is pointing backwards (like a 3/4 squat position). Your bodyweight should be centred over your feet but more towards your heels



To begin swinging the kettlebell you should hike the kettlebell behind you (similar to hiking the football in American Football but keep hold of the kettlebell), so it slightly stretches the hamstrings and preloads the posterior chain. Then in one continuous movement, you should extend your hips forcefully to propel the kettlebell along its arc till about chest height. The movement of the hips forward is similar to performing a two-legged standing broad jump, without jumping.

Your arms are just hooks, and the power comes from the movement of the hips and the muscles of the posterior chain, i.e., hamstrings, glutes, lower back.

The kettlebells should be swung to about chest height as swinging any higher is not efficient and there is little benefit to be gained by going higher. At the apex of the swing, you should breathe out while concentrating on fully extending your body and on contracting your quads, glutes and your abs. Your abs can be targeted by focusing on tilting your pelvis up at the top of the swing.



Breathe in and hold your breath as you let the kettlebell free fall back between your legs so that it passes through your legs as high as possible (to keep the arc tight and to stop unnecessary pulling on your back). Aim for your groin and then get your groin out of the way by taking your hips back.

One of the most important aspects of the swing is that the hips should move backwards so that the posterior chain (hamstrings & glutes mostly) is loaded to enable power for the subsequent swing. Different trainees will have varying degrees of knee flexion, however, if the trainee is feeling the movement more in their quads then they are not taking the hips back correctly at the bottom of the swing and are instead squatting up the kettlebell. If your quads are instead fatiguing, then you are not taking the hips back at the lower part of the movement.

Kettlebell Squat

The kettlebell squat is a killer squat variation. I'll talk about what makes it a unique exercise and why you should incorporate it into your routine.

Among other things, the placement of the weight in the front of the body in the kettlebell squat makes it easier on the spine and knees and easier to stay in proper position than in, say, a traditional barbell back squat. I'd go as far as to say the kettlebell squat is a superior exercise for your average person who lacks the flexibility, mobility, and core strength to perform a back squat with good form.



The movement is performed by sitting back like you're seated in a chair. The back stays flat, the spine stays lengthened, and the chest stays tall. Everyone is going to have a slightly different foot position, but a narrower stance than 'typical' is indicated. Most people will do well between the shoulder and hip width apart.

You can integrate this exercise into your routine a lot of different ways - as always, practice the movement and perfect your form before you start plugging it into your regular workouts. Try practising the workout at the beginning of your workouts with a sub-maximal weight for a nice warm up and to refine your technique.

The kettlebell squat is another one of the essential basic kettlebell drills. It's a superior choice to other forms of the squat for many people. Take the time to learn the movement properly, and you'll be glad you did!

Kettlebell Snatch

This is a combination of the kettlebell press and swing. Start with the kettlebell between your legs. Swing it back then quickly swing it back up all the way so that your arm is directly above your head. Then swing it back down between your legs and back up. This combination exercise will burn off some serious calories while working both sets of muscles that the press and swing target.

The kettlebell snatch has been referred to by Russians as the Czar of all kettlebell lifts! This lift is significant in building you a superior core with hip power and shoulder strength to give you unbelievable explosive power. This lift will also give you the grip strength that is noticed with every handshake. A common question that I get about the snatch lift is, “When should I attempt it?”



Well, the truth is that you must learn the proper form of the swings first. This is where you have to learn about the “arc” of your swing and where it should be. You see the arc of your swing should be close to your body. It is not about swinging the bell at a wide angle away from your body. This can only be done by you learning how to utilise your lat to contract with the load of the swing. You also should be able to truly lock out your arms overhead without any forward angle from your shoulder and arm. If you can’t lock out your arms overhead with the kettlebell press forming a straight line from your ankles to your wrist, then you shouldn’t be snatching the bell. The key is to first work on your shoulder mobility and flexibility. Once you practice on stretching and improving the mobility of your shoulder, then you can worry about attempting the snatch. You should also be aware that you shouldn’t allow the bell to

“bang” or “slap” your forearm when performing this lift. If this happens you either have too much weight, your technique is poor, or the arc of your swing is too wide! This is the key to snatching. Learn how to tame the arc before moving forward.



Kettlebell Figure 8 Abs Exercise

The Kettlebell Figure 8 is one of the many unique abdominal movements you can perform with a Kettlebell. However, It's believed that almost all Kettlebell movements work your core region.

Here's how to perform the Kettlebell Figure 8 exercise:

Stand with your feet slightly wider than shoulder-width apart. Place one kettlebell directly beneath and in between your legs. Keep your abs tight and back straight as you grab the Kettlebell with one hand.

Now push the Kettlebell backwards, through your legs and grab it with the other hand. Swing it around to the outside of your other leg, and swing back past through your legs and grab it with the original hand.

Think of dribbling a basketball

The Kettlebell Figure 8 is best done with lower repetitions. It is not like a traditional sit-up or crunch, where you need to perform lots of repetitions to feel the movement. In fact, you'll feel it within the first repetition. Start off slow and get the technique right or else you can very easily injure your lower back or pull a hamstring muscle. And, just like all Kettlebell movements, do not let the Kettlebell control you.

Don't be a macho man (or woman). If you can't handle the weight, practice it with no weight, and then with a light weight.



Kettlebell Russian Twist

To really target the side of the waist, you need to include some rotational exercise. This also ensures you have a core that is strong in all directions - if you only focus on normal flexion exercises, then you will have a weakness that sets you up for injury.

Most people do not include any rotational exercise in their fitness programme at all, yet it is extremely important for ensuring you are truly strong throughout the midsection, not just in certain directions, to protect the back. Rotation is more obviously needed in swinging or throwing sports, such as golf or cricket, but did you know that walking and running actually need your muscles to work well in the rotation?

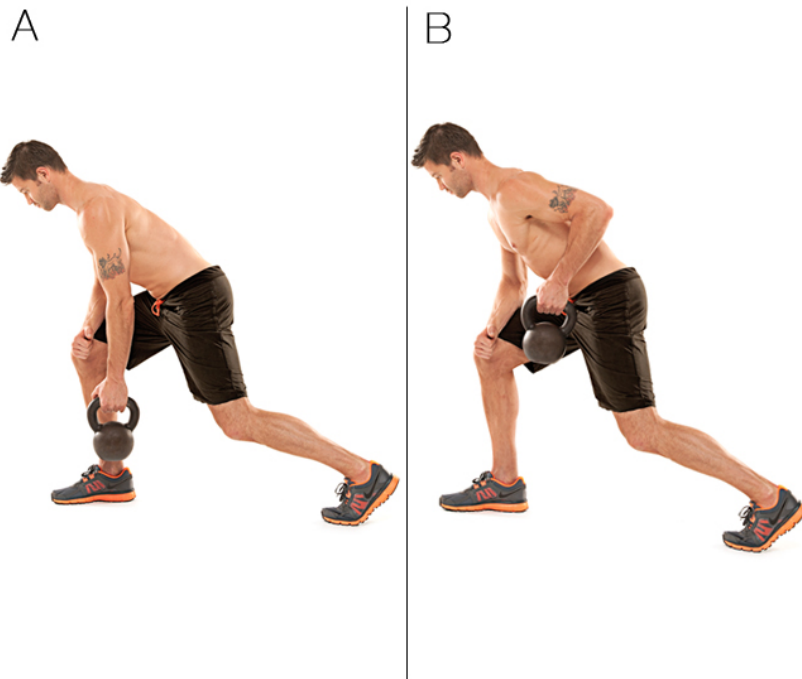
- Sit tall, keeping your chest lifted and making sure you are not rounding through the back. The kettlebell starts on one side of you, by your hip.
- The advanced variation is to perform this with your feet off the floor, just be very careful to ensure you do not round the lower back. If you can't sit tall with the feet off the floor, keep the feet down, heels touching the floor and knees bent.
- Pick the kettlebell up and, keeping the chest lifted, bring the kettlebell over your lap and across to the other side.
- Let the kettlebell touch the ground by your hip then lift it back up again and switch sides. Repeat for the required number of reps.



Kettlebell Rows

The kettlebell row is a cool variation on the traditional bent-over row. Like a traditional bent-over row performed with barbells or dumbbells, this exercise primarily works the muscles of the back, such as the lats, rhomboids, and mid and lower traps, but it also works the legs, core, and hips. I'm going to talk about a few different variations of the KB row and how this movement can be incorporated into your existing routine.

If you are doing this exercise properly, no matter what variation you are performing, you should push your butt back behind you as much as possible to begin the movement. You should almost be able to sit there and 'chill out' for a while without having your legs burn - this tells you that your body is in the proper position.



On to a quick description of four different variations of the movement:

The one arm kettlebell row

Take a staggered stance. The KB will go next to your front foot. Drive the elbow up towards the ceiling. Keep the elbow in close to the body. Bring the 'bell up to about even with your stomach. In all

of these variations, visualizing your back muscles working while you do the exercise is crucial.

The two arm kettlebell row

This is a cool variation of the traditional KB row. Take a wide stance. Both kettlebells will go between your feet. Start the movement by pulling both 'bells up to your stomach.

The two arm alternating kettlebell row

This variation is similar to the two arm KB row in set-up and execution, except that you will be rowing with only one arm at a time. Hold one kettlebell up to the body while you row with the other arm.

The 'renegade' alternating kettlebell row

This is a killer variation that incorporates a whole lot of additional muscle groups - this is pretty darn close to a full body movement. Assume a push-up position with a hand on each kettlebell. Shift your weight to one kettlebell, while you do a row with the other one.

These are the four main variations of the KB row. Enjoy, and start incorporating this basic kettlebell exercise (and the above variations of it) into your routine today!

Turkish Get Ups

Turkish Get Up is an ancient practice that is possibly about 300 years old. It is commonly performed by many strong men in the past. For anyone who wants to develop overall strength, total fitness, and functionality, this is an exercise that must be done. Although it is an old exercise, it is up til today an exercise that is part of the exercise routine of every top athlete. The Turkish Get Up is best done with a kettlebell as it helps keep the arm straight and vertical as it hangs off the back of your hand.

If you don't want to train each body part separately and you want one exercise that will build strength over your entire body, keep your body in excellent condition while training all your muscle groups to work together, then the number one exercise for that would have to be the Turkish Get-Up (TGU).

If you don't know what the Turkish get-up is, it's a full body exercise which basically takes you from a lying down position to a standing one; this sounds very basic, and in reality it is but when performed correctly with the right amount of weight it is a perfect exercise for strengthening the entire body. As with any exercise, there are a few variations which you can perform like the lounge TGU, the squat TGU and the two handed TGU, although you will find the lounge style to be the most commonly used. The best equipment that you can utilize for the Turkish get-up is the kettlebell it is going to provide you with the necessary resistance needed.

How to perform the Turkish-Get Up

Start by Lying on your back with your chosen weight beside you then using both hands raise the weight so that you are holding it in a straight arm perpendicular to the floor, once it is up and steady you can return the other arm to the floor.

Plant the foot that is on the same side as the weight close to your glutes and punch the weight into the air by contracting your abdominals and pushing with the planted foot so that you rise to your side and can rest on your opposite elbow, from here you can sit up further so that you are resting on your hand.

Now lift your body off the ground using the planted foot and the hand that is supporting you and tuck your other leg under and behind you so that you are kneeling on it, from here you bring your torso up to a vertical position.

Once you are steady in the kneeling position you simply stand up and that's it, you have just completed a Turkish get-up, now you can reverse these steps to go back down.



Important Points

- Keep your arm locked out and vertical the entire time, control over the weight is crucial
- Keep your eyes on the weight; this will help keep it under control
- Your shoulder must remain sunk, so it's nice and tight and not loose.

Benefits of the Turkish Get-Up

The Turkish get-up has many benefits, as already mentioned it is for strengthening and conditioning the entire body, but it also helps to build good balance and coordination. Also, it is a great rehabilitating the shoulder as it builds good strength and stability in the joint. In

fact, the Turkish get-up with moderately light weights is possibly the best exercise you could do for shoulder rehabilitation provided it is performed correctly.



So that's it, if you are looking for that one exercise that is going to build great overall strength, condition your body and improve your balance and coordination as a bonus then you shouldn't look past the Turkish get-up.

Kettlebell Push Up To Row

To progress onto the full kettlebell push up to row is a battle that we all can win but one that is going to take time. Performing this kettlebell exercises can and should be seen as a challenge in itself, and there exists a basic path for which we can all follow to ensure we can get where we need to get.

The first step to ensuring you can perform the kettlebell push up to row is to practice the plank position. To do this simply lie face down and using your toes and forearms for support lift your body a couple of inches off the floor. Simply holding this position for as long as you can, you will find that you will increase your core strength and, in fact, this can be an excellent abs exercise in itself.

The next step will be to introduce Kettlebells to your Plank routine. Once you can hold your plank position for one minute at a time introduce the Kettlebells. To do this, you will simply get yourself into the press up position pushing the kettlebells into the ground. At this stage you will be supporting your weight with your toes and hands pressing into the Kettlebells and will be in a slightly inclined position, so your body will go upwards with your head being further off the ground than your feet will be.



The next stage will be to take the position described above and perform push-ups. To do so simply lower yourself down in between the set of Kettlebells you are using to hold and support your weight and drive back upwards pushing the Kettlebells into the ground with as much force as possible. Once you can perform three sets of 20

repetitions, you will be ready to move onto the full kettlebell push up to row.

Taking everything from the above exercises, you now need to support your weight using your toes and your hands which will be pushing into the Kettlebells. Bring your legs out to a slightly wider position than you would for the push-up and push the Kettlebell in your right hand down into the floor. While doing this lift the Kettlebell in your left hand towards your Chest in a rowing fashion. At the top of the movement focus on squeezing the Last and return the Kettlebell towards the floor and push it into the floor as you then begin to row the Kettlebell in your right hand towards your Chest.

This is a very basic plan on how to perform the Kettlebell Renegade Row.



Kettlebell Lunges

Kettlebell Lunges are an exercise that targets the quadriceps, glutes, hamstrings and calf muscles. Because of the unilateral movement required of this exercise, the core muscles will be activated. Holding the Kettlebells during the lunge for an extended period will also help build the forearms and traps.

Kettlebell Lunge is also useful for sports that require frequent lunging movements such as tennis, badminton, fencing, boxing and those that demand hip stability and mobility like soccer, football, and basketball.

To do a kettlebell lunge, step forward with your right foot and go down into a lunge position. Once you are in a full lunge position, pass the kettlebell through your legs to your other hand, and then stand back up straight again. Step forward with your left foot and repeat the steps again as many times as needed.

Backward stepping lunge

You will find these are the easiest method for learning the lunge and getting used to the balance. Anyone with tricky knees will appreciate this progression, as it allows you to control the pressure on your knees completely.

Forward stepping walking lunge

The forward stepping lunge is a little bit more challenging than the backward stepping lunge and can be turned into a walking lunge for many variations.

Lunge with rotation

Lunges can be combined with various movements in the upper body for variation. The lunge with rotation is one of my favorites.

Lunge and Press

Combining lunges with a shoulder press will demand a high level of tension in your core, this is a full body exercise that you will truly feel all over your body.

Split lunge

The split lunge is an excellent way to lengthen out tight quads and hip flexors, which is a common problem for people today. Not only will these lunges lengthen your hip flexors but more importantly

they will teach them strength in the greater range of motion. Beware, these will make you sore!

Tactical Lunge

The tactical lunge will make the balance of the lunge more difficult because the bell will swing side to side while your feet are in a long, linear stride. Make sure you keep your back flat and sit down into your hips. People often round their backs trying to get down low enough to transition the bell.

Power Lunge

Like the split lunge, these will make you very sore. However, the split lunge focuses that soreness in your Quads and hip flexors and these will be more of an all over the soreness. If you have knee pain or previous injuries, be careful with this progression.

Lunge figure eight

Swinging a kettlebell from hand to hand, switching to your leg with each lunge. This progression will take strength, stability, balance and determination, proceed with caution!



This Simple Kettlebell Workout Quickly Gets You In Shape

If you want simple kettlebell workouts because you're new to the idea of using kettlebells for fitness, or just because you're currently out of shape and you want to ease into a workout routine slowly, let me give you a plan that will get you back into the 'swing' of things in no time flat.

Begin with the basics

There's no point in using complex, intense movements while you're still learning and increasing your conditioning to the point where you can work out without feeling like you're going to collapse. Start with the basics and move on only when you feel like you need an additional challenge.

The fundamental kettlebell exercise is the kettlebell swing. This movement is the foundation upon which most beginners' kettlebell workouts are built.

Don't shortchange yourself on kettlebell swings; they build up your muscular endurance and gently ease your body into the exercise habit. When you include swings in your routine, before you know it you'll be strong and fit, with a limber body that easily makes the transition to harder and more demanding kettlebell moves.

Push and pull, always in balance

Upper body exercises can be divided into two main types: push and pull movements.

Pushing moves work your chest, shoulders, and triceps. Pulling moves work your upper back and biceps.

If you don't include both pushing and pulling moves in your workout routine, your body will eventually become unbalanced. You don't want that, because that's a sure-fire way to get injured.

For your push workout, try supersetting some overhead kettlebell presses with some pushups. Use a light kettlebell and don't try to be a hero. Your goal for this simple workout isn't to move as much

weight possible; rather, you should think in terms of getting in shape and increasing your muscular endurance.

As you move on to your pull workout, try some simple kettlebell rows supersetted with kettlebell upright rows. If you are strong enough, you can't go wrong with some pullups too.

Don't forget the legs

You did remember to do your kettlebell swings, right? Swings work the legs and lower back and they're a fantastic conditioning move. But you should do some direct leg work because that's the **quickest** way to get flexible and in shape in as little time as possible.

To give your legs some work, try kettlebell suitcase squats or kettlebell lunges. Suitcase squats are easier because there is no skill involved, but you'll need two 'bells. Lunges, on the other hand, require you to rack the kettlebell in the crook of your arm. But no worries because this gives you the perfect excuse to learn the kettlebell clean.

4 week training program

Week 1 Kettlebell Basics

Day 1: Swing, Squat, Russian Twist. 2 sets, 15 reps, 30 sec rest between exercises

Day 2: Swing, Squat, Russian Twist. 3 sets, 15 reps, 30 sec rest between exercises

Day 3: Swing, Squat, Russian Twist. 3 sets, 15 reps, 30 sec rest between exercises

Day 4: Swing, Squat, Russian Twist. Do all exercises for 30 seconds without rest. Rest 30 seconds between each giant set.

Week 2 Upper body / Lower body / Core

Day 1: Swing, Snatch, Press, Row. 3 sets of 20 reps. 30 seconds between exercises.

Day 2: Squat, Russian twist, Figure 8. 3 sets of 20 reps. 30 sec between exercises.

Day 3: Swing, Press, Snatch, Row, 3 sets. Do all exercises for 45 seconds without rest. Rest 30 seconds between each giant set.

Day 4: Squat, Lunge, Russian twist, Figure 8. 3 sets. Do all exercises for 45 seconds without rest. Rest 30 seconds between each giant set.

Week 3 Advanced Exercises

Day 1: Turkish Get ups, Swing, Kettlebell Push up To Row, Snatch. 3 sets, 10 reps, 30 seconds between exercises

Day 2: Turkish Get ups, Swing, Kettlebell Push up To Row, Snatch. 3 sets, 20 reps, 30 seconds between exercises

Day 3: Turkish Get ups, Swing, Kettlebell Push up To Row, Snatch. 3 sets, 10 reps Do 10 reps from each exercises without rest. Rest 30 seconds between giant sets.

Day 4: Turkish Get ups, Swing, Kettlebell Push up To Row, Snatch. 3 sets, 20 reps, Do 20 reps from each exercises without rest. Rest 30 seconds between giant sets.

Week 4 Kettlebell Circuits / Cardio

Day 1: Perform each exercise consecutively for 30 seconds. Rest 60 seconds after each giant set. 3 circuits.

Day 2: Perform each exercise consecutively for 45 seconds. Rest 60 seconds after each giant set. 3 circuits.

Day 3: Perform each exercise consecutively for 60 seconds. Rest 45 seconds after each giant set. 3 circuits.

Day 4: Perform each exercise consecutively for 60 seconds. Rest 30 seconds after each giant set. 3 circuits.

Kettlebell FAQ's

What is a kettlebell?

A kettlebell is a cast iron weight that is shaped like a bowling ball with a thick suitcase-style handle. Kettlebells range in weight from 4kg (9 lbs) to 40kg (88 lbs).

How did kettlebells come into existence?

Kettlebells first appeared in Russia over 100 years ago. Originally kettlebells were used in fairs and markets to balance scales when weighing heavy objects. The Russian military began using them within their training regime because they demand an overhaul of all of the body's energy systems simultaneously.

Who uses kettlebells?

Kettlebells are used by a variety of people including stay-at-home mums, business professionals, athletes, martial artists, law enforcement, firemen, military, and other people who are looking for a more efficient and functional workout.

Why train with kettlebells?

Kettlebells are the ultimate all-in-one fitness and strength/conditioning tool. Kettlebells promote strength, cardio, flexibility, and mobility all at the same time with a special emphasis on CORE STRENGTH. This type of training is perfect for those looking for 'the most out of the least' thus maximising workouts. Anyone can gain noticeable benefits in 30-minute workouts a couple of times per week.

Are the kettlebell techniques difficult to learn?

At first, kettlebells look deceptively challenging. However, once you experience them, you will find that most people will be able to learn basic technique within 3-4 hours of hands-on instruction.

Why are you encouraged to ‘lock’ your joints when kettlebell training?

Kettlebell training contradicts most traditional weight training. By ‘locking’ your joints you are strengthening tendons and ligaments. You also train your body in compromising positions, under careful surveillance, so you are hopefully able to withstand minor injuries or avoid injuries altogether in the future.

Do kettlebells hurt your back during certain exercises?

Kettlebells don’t hurt your back if you are using correct form. At first, they look to be dangerous, which is correct, as are most forms of weight training if you don’t receive proper instruction.

Am I cut out to work with kettlebells?

Most people regardless of current or previous injuries, training background, age or physical condition will find kettlebells a refreshing break from the normal workout routine. Kettlebells are definitely more challenging but also extremely fun at the same time.

What type of results can I expect when using kettlebells?

Kettlebells develop a lean, strong, and graceful look. Many are amazed at how quickly they ‘feel’ the benefits. The energy you will receive from kettlebell training allows you to finish your workout ‘full of life’. You will also become less susceptible to injuries because you are training in all three planes of movement rather than a single plane which most traditional training methods address.

Can I get a total body workout using only one kettlebell?

Yes, you can! The combinations are ENDLESS. The creativity of your kettlebell routine is ONLY limited to your own mind or your trainer’s mind.

Can I build strength without size with kettlebells?

Yes. Kettlebells address strength gain through the central nervous system than traditional weight training. You will feel more 'connected' after a few weeks of kettlebell training. You can build size with kettlebells but it takes a lot more time and effort, but it takes diligent dedication to do so.

How do I know which weight to start with?

Most females will begin with either the 9kg (18 lbs) or 12kg (26 lbs.). Most males will begin with either the 16kg (36 lbs) or 24kg (53 lbs). Although you will be gun-shy when starting, most people rapidly move up to the next size kettlebell. Consult with Amber or Brad in order to best customise your needs.

What kind of footwear is worn during kettlebell workouts?

Barefoot is ideal so you can have a better 'connection' with the ground, but another option is flat-soled shoes. Flat-soled shoes are highly recommended so you can 'grip and feel' the ground with your feet. Examples of some types and brands would be Adidas soccer shoes, Converse Chuck Taylor's, Diesel, Puma, and Steve Madden just to name a few. You should avoid wearing 'running' shoes because the extra cushioning spells disaster for potential injuries when training with kettlebells.

What is 'joint mobility'?

Joint mobility is creating and or re-creating a range of motion that already exists within the joints, muscles and other tissues of the body. Joint mobility is a combination of bodyweight callisthenics, tai chi, and dynamic warm-ups all complementary of each other facilitating new-found harmony throughout the entire body. Freedom of movement usually needs to be re-introduced to most people due to the ageing process and conditioning of the way we think and move.

What is the difference between 'joint mobility' and flexibility?

Joint mobility provides a life-simulated approach to movement. We live in the three-dimensional world; therefore, we should train in a

more realistic fashion. Joint mobility and kettlebells combine to provide a synergy unmatched in the health and fitness, strength and conditioning industries.

I'm 65 years old, weak, inflexible, and don't have good balance. Can I use kettlebells and joint mobility?

Yes, you can! Once your physician has cleared you, you are ready to begin an exercise program. Kettlebells and joint mobility are exactly what you need in order to reverse the ageing process.

I have previous injuries including torn rotator cuffs, torn ACL, and a bad back. Will kettlebells help or aggravate these injuries?

Under close supervision, kettlebells and joint mobility will help all of these injuries become less, if not eliminate, all of these issues.

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